From The Operator's Thesis: How Healthcare Really Buys AI (Saivai Group, 2026) — editable reader copy of the printed instrument; text identical to the book. © 2026 Anthony W. Russell. For the reader's own use; not legal, clinical, compliance, investment, accounting, tax, or consulting advice. Reader resource hub: saivaigroup.com/thesis

Appendix A — The Operator's Toolkit

The instruments below convert this book's frameworks into working diligence and governance tools. All seventeen appear here in full. Three of them, the sheets most readers will use first, appear as fill-in worksheets and a checklist; the rest are deliberately compact prose, because an instrument you can hold in one read is an instrument you will actually use. These instruments are aids to structured thinking based on the author's operating experience. They are not legal, clinical, compliance, investment, accounting, tax, or consulting advice; they do not establish a standard of care or guarantee diligence or outcomes. Use them with qualified professionals and your own judgment. See the Author's Note.

Before the Instruments: The Small-System Start

If the process in this book reads like it was built for a system with forty people to throw at it, it was, because that is who the enterprise gauntlet was built by. If you are smaller, do not run the gauntlet. Run these five moves; each points to the one instrument that carries it.

1. One owner, one page. Name the sponsor, signer, implementer, and user: four names, one page (Instrument 5). If two of those names are the same person, write it down anyway; the vacancies are the finding.
2. Price the whole bill. One hour with whoever holds your budget and the Price-Plus-Burden worksheet (Instrument 3). If the vendor cannot help you fill in the right-hand column, that is your answer.
3. Charter before pilot. Six lines in a table (Instrument 8). If any line cannot be filled in, the pilot is not ready, and that discovery is free today and expensive in month four.
4. Round on the change, weekly. The checklist's standing six (Instrument 16) takes fifteen minutes and replaces the meeting nobody scheduled.
5. Book the renewal decision before go-live. Put the date, the owner, and the evidence you will require on the calendar now (Instrument 11). The renewal is the verdict; schedule the courtroom.

That is the whole starter path. An enterprise process does not scale down; judgment does, and these five moves are the judgment.